

to take revenge. A disturbed neighbourhood is ominous for India too. There seems to be no respite for our country from the scourge of terrorism.

ANNIE SAMSON, *Delhi*

Mahal of Opportunity

With Taj Mahal retaining its status as one of the seven wonders of the world, it is obvious that it will receive hordes of international tourists ("Not So Wonderful", July 23). The opportunity can be exploited in full only if world-class amenities are provided to visitors. The Government needs to draw out an appropriate strategy to attract tourists.

NANDINI SANYAL, *Delhi*

Don't Retard Retail

Retail is poised to be the next big sector in India with a huge potential ("Red Signal for Retail", July 23). Instead of opposing the entry of large retail chains in Kerala, political parties should try and gauge the changing trend. The new buzzword in the Indian retail mart, organised retail has a huge potential in terms of growth and employment.

REEJA, *on e-mail*

Organised retail in India has undergone a major makeover in the past couple of years. However, that doesn't mean it can throttle small traders. Shopping is still synonymous with street stores for an average Indian, although with changing lifestyles and strong income growth, people no longer hesitate to enter malls that present convenience and choice—

everything together.

LATA RAGHAVAN, *on e-mail*

Pseudo-secular

The concept of secularity is not clear in India. The Left rejected the candidature of Shivraj Patil for the post of President as he was "non-secular". He was disqualified as he was a devotee of Satya Sai Baba. The Left has now nominated Hamid Ansari of the Minorities Commission for the post of vice-president. Ansari is as devout as any other Muslim

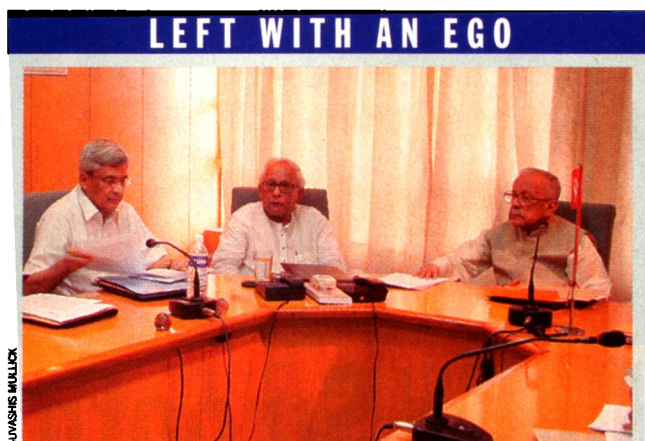
is—he prays at a mosque and recites the namaz. Can he be called 'secular'?

K.R. RAVI, *on e-mail*

A Step Forward

It's encouraging to know that the Andhra Pradesh Government is trying to snatch away land from illegal occupants ("The Law of the Land", July 16). However, the Government should take more stern and strong action to eradicate this age-old menace.

AJAY TALUKDAR, *Hyderabad*



SUNSHINE MULLICK

LEFT WITH AN EGO

Patriarchs of the Left parties should stop fighting among themselves like old "boys" ("Command Failure", July 23). In fact, the command should now be passed on to young pragmatists who are ready to accept change.

JYOTSNA MANSUKHANI, *Delhi*

It is unfair to blame Left cadres alone. Be it CPI(M), the Congress or BJP, fights happen within all political parties. DMK was recently gripped by a controversy when M. Karunanidhi favoured his son Stalin over grandnephew Dayanidhi Maran.

MOUSUMI SENGUPTA, *Kolkata*

It is sad that the growing discord within the CPI(M) is not because of ideological differences but petty bourgeois personal hostilities. The party should not make its internal fights public.

T.S. PATTABHI RAMAN, *on e-mail*

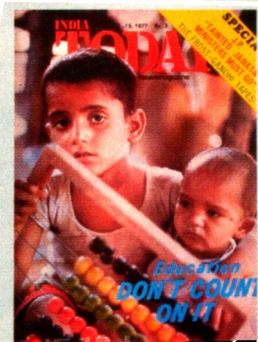
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Years Ago in India Today

AUGUST 1-15, 1977



President Reddy

Less than 24 hours before he was sworn in as President of India on July 5, Neelam Sanjiva Reddy gave an exclusive half-hour interview to INDIA TODAY. Following are excerpts.

Entry into Politics: I entered politics as a student under the inspiration of Mahatma

Gandhi in 1932.

On Indian Politicians:

The moral force of



Reddy

Gandhi we don't see now. And Jawaharlalji had a different type of control over the people. He appeared to be little materialistic, but still, he did manage to communicate with people in an effective and honest way. It was only after Lal Bahadur Shastri died that the motivation changed.

On His Own Role as

President: I would like to build bridges between parties and people to improve the integration of India. Without getting involved in day-to-day politics, I can help the Government at the Centre and the states.

—Sunil Sethi